

UNIT 05

DIGITAL CITIZENSHIP



Student Learning Outcomes:

After the completion of this unit students will be able to:

- Understand the essentials of a good digital citizen.
- Define copyright, plagiarism, and piracy
- Understand ethical issues that arise in ICT while surfing online.
- Identify the health-related issues of using ICT Devices.



Introduction to the Unit:

This unit will cover important aspects of digital citizenship. Our purpose is to prepare students for the global technology demand of the future. This unit also defines terms like copyright, plagiarism, and piracy. Here we also discuss health-related issues while using ICT devices.

5.1 Citizen and citizenship

A citizen is a person who belongs to a country or nation. Citizenship means being a member of a country. When you are a citizen, you belong to a place like you are citizens of Pakistan. It gives you rights, like the right to vote and the right to be protected by the laws of your country. Citizenship also comes with responsibilities such as obeying rules, helping others and being a good member of your community.



Figure 5.1 Citizens of Pakistan and Other Countries

5.2 Digital citizenship

Digital citizenship is the ability to be involved with the Internet or technology in a meaningful and safe way. If you are playing online games using social media or applying online for a passport through the NADRA website, then you are a digital citizen.



5.2.1 Good Digital Citizens Use ICT Devices with Care and Responsibility

A good digital citizen has the knowledge and skill to use ICT devices with care and responsibility. Here are some tips to be a good digital citizen and stay safe and responsible while using the Internet.



Figure 5.2 Good Digital Citizen

I. Stay Private

Never share your personal information online like your parent's name, phone number, date of birth, password, ATM PIN or home address etc. with any website or person.



II. Strangers are not your friend

Never befriend strangers online, this can be dangerous for your safety. People may not be who they claim online.



III. Use a strong password

Never use your name or date of birth as your password these types of passwords are easy to guess. Use combination alphabet, digits and special characters (*, ?, !, @, #, \$..) as password.



IV. Ask permission

It's always good to ask your parent or teacher if you can use the Internet or ICT devices. It is a good idea to ask for recommended websites to help you stay safe. Never take a picture of someone without permission.



Take permission from your parents before using ICT Device

V. Be kind

Treat people the way you would like to be treated on social media or during online classes never use inappropriate language or make rude comments online, always communicate kindly on social media and talk kindly.



VI. Tell your elder

If you see or experience something that is not right (such as online bullying or trolling), tell your parents or teacher to get support.



Note for Teachers

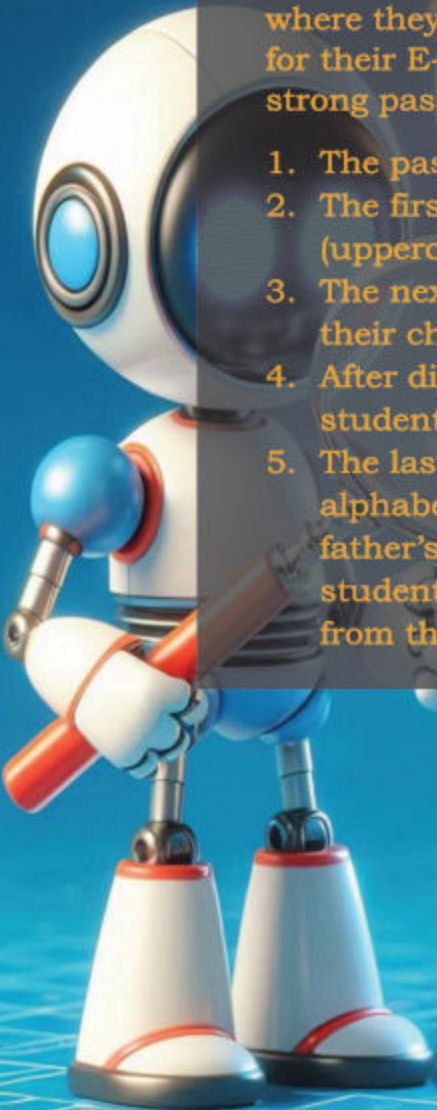
Digital footprint is the record of your data while using the internet or social media it also includes your search history which can be seen by your parents or teachers.



Note

ONLINE TROLLING OR BULLYING

When someone intentionally tries to insult, cause trouble or directly attack people by posting harsh comments on social media

A small, white and blue robot with a large head and a single arm, holding a red tool. It is standing on a blue grid floor. In the background, there is a large blue padlock and a red key.

ACTIVITY

The teacher involves the students in an activity where they learn to develop a strong password for their E-mail account. Each student creates a strong password by using these rules.

1. The password should be 8 characters long.
2. The first character must be the 1st alphabet (uppercase) of the student's favorite fruit.
3. The next three characters must be their choice.
4. After digits use any special character of the student's choice.
5. The last three characters will be lowercase alphabets taken one letter from the student's father's name, one alphabet from the student's mother's name and one alphabet from the student's name



Tip to remember

Never use the same password for all of your accounts

5.3 ICT Ethics

ICT ethics is suitable behavior while using the internet and computer devices

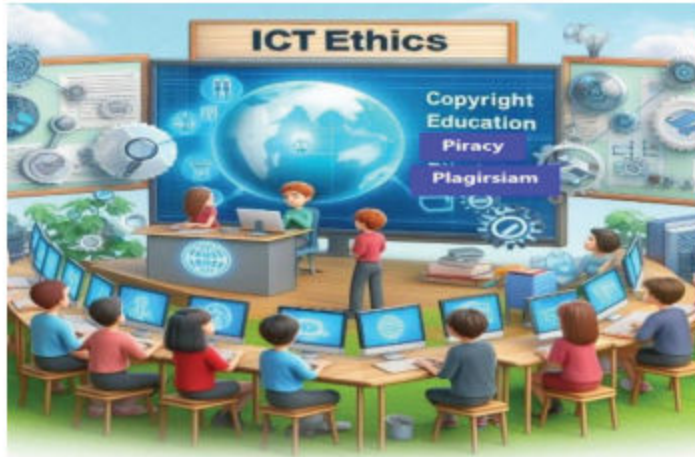


Figure 5.3 ICT Ethics

Note

The main characteristic of computer ethics is to use ICT devices and the Internet without harming people's privacy and obeying the laws related to copyright and software piracy and plagiarism.

5.3.1 Copyright Law

Copyright law is a protection given by the government to creators and developers to prevent unauthorized use of their work without their permission. This includes music, videos, images and documents.



Figure 5.4 Copyright Law

To use copyrighted material, you must get permission from the owner. Let's suppose you write a poem for your teacher and one of your friends uses your poem in his essay without telling/asking you, this is a violation of copyright law. Every country has its copyright laws and one can get fined and imprisoned if he/she does not obey these laws.

5.3.2 Plagiarism

Plagiarism is the use or copying of another person's ideas, words, drawings, art, music, etc., and presenting it as one's own without acknowledging the author or obtaining their permission.

Let's suppose a student copies their friend's drawing and claims it as their own in front of the class; this is plagiarism.



Figure 5.5 Plagiarism

5.3.3 Piracy

The term piracy comes from the word "pirates". Piracy involves downloading, selling, and using copyrighted games, music, movies, TV shows, photographs, and software without paying the price. For example, If you want to play a computer game online that requires payment and you do not pay and play the same computer game through pirated websites. It is piracy.



Figure 5.6 Piracy

 Note



The word Pirates belong to thieves in old times they stole from people traveling through the sea .

Stay Safe Online / Good Digital Citizen	
DO ✓	Don't ✗

5.4 Ethical Issues of ICT while Surfing Online

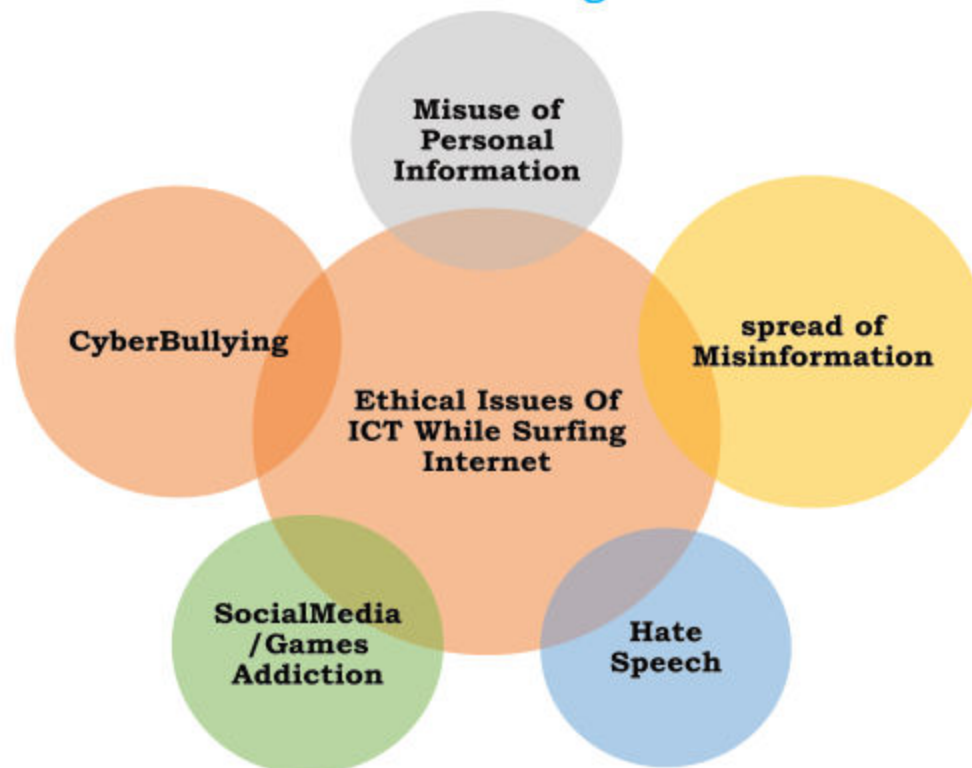


Figure 5.7 Ethical issue of ICT while surfing the Internet

The use of ICT devices and the Internet raises many ethical issues some of which are given below.

I. Misuse of personal data

We should be careful about sharing personal information online. If malicious individuals have your name, photo, DOB, etc., they can create your fake account using your details and try to deceive your friends, family anyone. If someone uses your personal information, you should tell your parents or teacher so they can help you to stay safe.

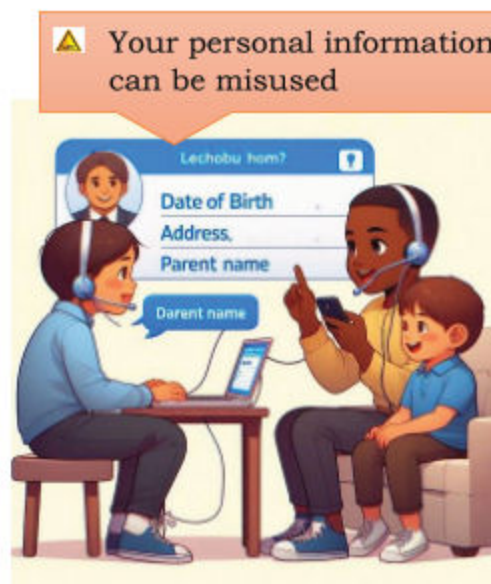


Figure 5.7 (a) Misuse of personal information

II. Spread of misinformation

Misinformation is defined as inaccurate or misleading information that is shared online without the aim of misleading others. It is by mistake shared online by a person or group that shares the information and thinks it to be true.



Figure 5.7 (b) Spread of misinformation

III. Hate Speech

Hate speech means posting bad or harsh comments, pictures, or videos on the internet about people because of their race, religion and gender. If we encounter hate speech online, it's important to inform our parents so they can help us address it. For example, posting harsh comments to target ethnic minorities.

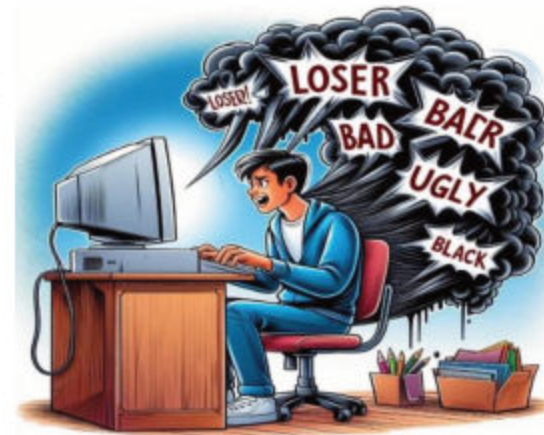


Figure 5.7 (c) Hate speech

IV. Social media/Games addiction

Games and social media are designed to attract people to them, and children can easily become addicted because they are not mature enough to handle it. Parents and teachers are responsible for teaching them how to manage their time wisely. If you skip your meals to play computer games then you are addicted to them.



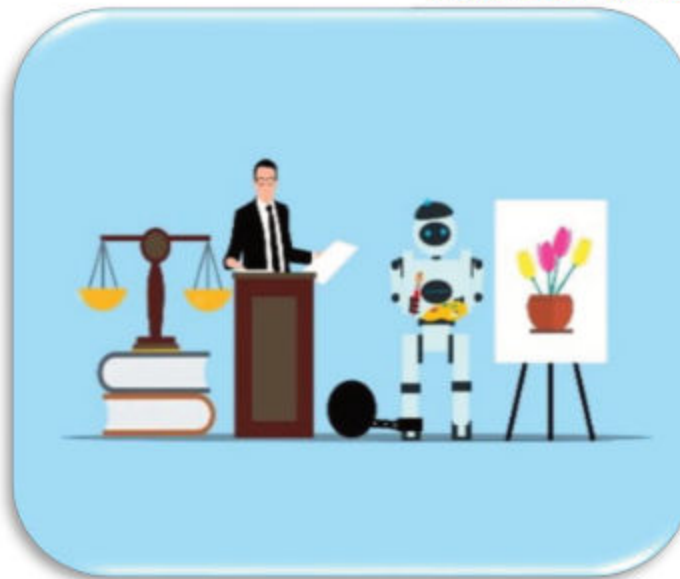
Figure 5.7 (d) social Media/Games addiction

V. Cyberbullying

Cyberbullying is repeatedly making hurtful or harsh comments about another person online, starting rumors or uploading embarrassing images or videos online. Cyberbullying can occur via email, online games, texting, and social media. For example, whenever you post your picture on Facebook one of your friends always posts harsh comments on it. This is cyberbullying.



Figure 5.7 (e) Cyber bullying



Cyber Crime

Note

Cyber Crime is any illegal activity done by using an ICT device on the internet for example Cyberbullying, or software piracy. Every country has its cyber laws to counter cybercrimes.

5.5 Health-Related Issues While Using ICT Devices

Spending too much time on ICT devices can damage our health and make us feel tired or sad. Health-related issues for children using ICT devices include

I. Eye Stress

Continuous use of ICT devices can cause eye strain. To reduce eye strain, we should follow the 20-20-20 rule which is, while working on the computer after every 20 minutes, look at something 20 feet away for 20 seconds.



Figure 5.8 Eye stress

II. Poor Posture

Sitting on one side or dropping your head toward the computer stresses your body and leads to poor posture as shown in Figure 5.9.

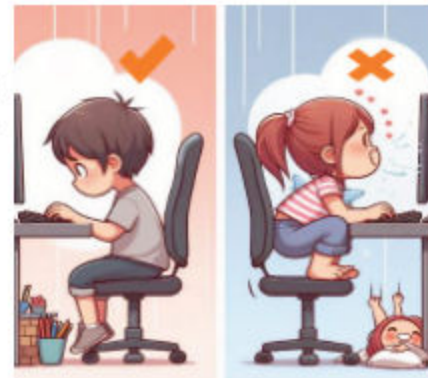


Figure 5.9 Poor posture vs Proper posture

III. Physical Inactivity and Obesity

If we spend too much time sitting using ICT devices then we will become physically inactive and this will lead to obesity and health issues. To avoid these issues we should limit our screen time.



Figure 5.10 Physical inactivity due to excess screen time can lead to obesity

IV. Sleep Disorders

The blue light emitted by ICT devices can upset our body's normal sleep-wake cycle. To avoid this sleep disorder we should have a bedtime rule which is to turn off ICT devices at least one hour before sleeping.



Figure 5.11 The blue light produced by ICT devices can disturb your sleep

V. Exposure To Radiation

All electronic devices, including laptops and mobile phones use radiofrequency energy (a form of electromagnetic radiation). These radiations are not harmful unless you are on your computer less than four hours a day. Limiting screen time can help reduce potential risks.



Figure 5.12 Excessive use of ICT devices exposes you to the danger of radiation

VI. Mental Health Problems

If children spend most of their time in front of ICT devices, they may develop mental health problems like tension, anxiety, and depression. Positive mental health can be achieved by limiting the usage of ICT devices and supporting good activities



Figure 5.13 Mental health Problems

ACTIVITY

The teacher guides students to fill out the below table about their daily usage of ICT devices and social media and calculate and their daily screen time.

Online activity	Time (in minutes)
Watching movies online	
Listening music	
Playing Games online	
Studying online	
Using social media	
Total screen time	



5.6 Keeping Proper Posture

Keeping proper posture while using a computer helps prevent discomfort and reduce the risk of health issues such as muscle pain. Below are a few guidelines for maintaining good posture when using a computer.

I. Use a back support chair

Always use a chair with proper support to keep your back in shape. Make sure that your feet are on the floor.



Figure 5.14 Use a back support

II. Always sit up straight while using ICT devices

Sit up straight while using ICT devices. Avoid slouching or leaning forward.



Figure 5.15 Sit up straight while using ICT

III. Put your arms parallel to the floor

Keep your arms parallel to the floor. Use armrests, if available, to support your arms and shoulders.



Figure 5.16 Put your arms parallel to the floor while using ICT

IV. Set the monitor at eye level

The upper edge of your computer monitor should be at or a little below eye level. Computer screen should be 18 to 25 inches away from you.

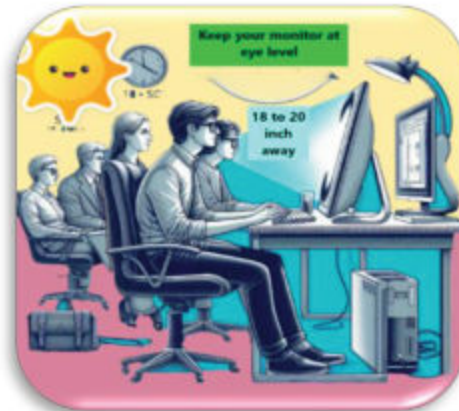


Figure 5.17 *Keep your monitor at eye*

V. Position the keyboard and mouse properly

Place the keyboard and mouse near and at a height that allows your elbows to bend at about a 90-degree angle.



Figure 5.18 *Keep mouse and keyboard within reach of your hands*

VI. Position the keyboard and mouse properly

While using the computer for more than one hour, you should take a break by getting up from your computer walk for a few minutes.



Figure 5.19 *Give yourself a break*

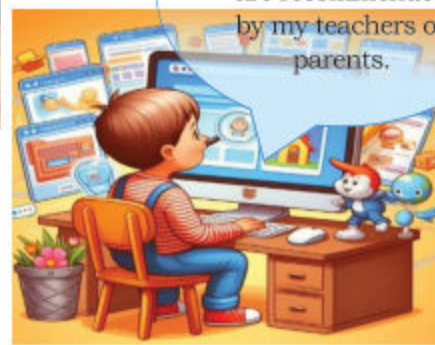
5.7 Computer Lab Rules For Students

1. Ask your teacher for permission before going in or out of the lab.
2. Get your teacher's permission before printing or downloading files.



I take permission from the teacher before using printer

I visit only those websites which are recommended by my teachers or parents.

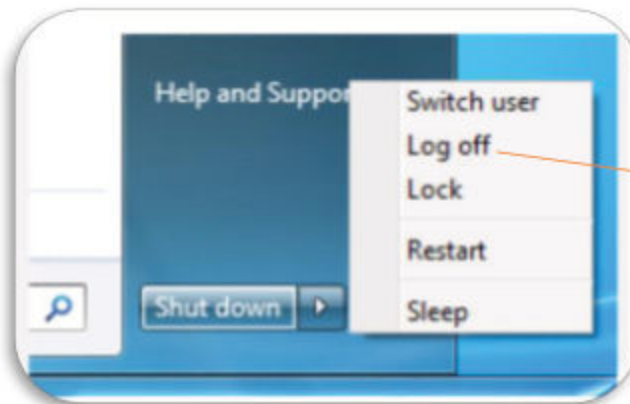


3. Browse through websites that your parents and instructor have recommended.
4. Use the computer in the computer lab that is assigned to you by your teacher.



My teacher assigned this computer to me

5. Save your files, log out of your account, and shut down your computer completely before you leave the lab.



Log off from your account and shut down the computer before leaving Computer Lab

6. The computer lab should be neat and tidy.



Keep computer Lab net and clean

7. Do not touch electric switches or move devices.



Never touch electric switches

8. Arrange your chair before leaving the lab.



I arrange my chair before leaving computer lab

Summary

- A person who legally belongs to a country and has the rights and protection of that country is called a citizen of that country.
- A digital citizen is a person who develops the skills and knowledge to efficiently use the internet and ICT.
- Digital citizenship is the ability to use ICT responsibly, safely and respectfully.
- A good digital citizen protects their personal information and treats others with respect.
- Copyright is a law that stops you from using other people's work without their permission
- Plagiarism refers to the act of using another's work as your own.
- Piracy is the unauthorized use, copying or distribution of copyrighted software.
- Working at a computer with improper posture causes back, neck and shoulder pains, headaches, eye strain and other injuries to the arms and hands.

Important Terms to Remember

Cybercrime: Cybercrime covers illegal activities conducted using ICT devices and the internet, including hacking, fraud, identity theft and online harassment.

Cyber Law: Cyber law is the legal area that regulates and governs the use of the internet and issues such as online privacy, cybersecurity, electronic commerce and digital rights.

Social Media: Social media refers to online platforms that allow users to create, share content and interact with other users

Unauthorized: Unauthorized refers to accessing something without proper authority or right.

Surfing the Internet: It means the act of browsing and exploring the World Wide Web.

Exercise

1. Encircle the correct answer.

- i. The unauthorized copying or distribution of copyrighted software is called
 - a. Piracy
 - b. Copyright
 - c. Eye strain
 - d. Plagiarism
- ii. Digital literacy refers to the skills and knowledge needed to assess, use, and create content.
 - a. Online
 - b. On notebook
 - c. On paper
 - d. On sketchbook
- iii. Committing any unlawful activity by using ICT devices and the internet is known as
 - a. Internet crime
 - b. Cybercrime
 - c. Internet law
 - d. Cyber law

- iv. Before leaving the lab, students should
 - a. Log off from their accounts.
 - b. Monitor
 - c. Shut down the assigned computers properly.
 - d. All of the above
- v. The top of your computer monitor should be at or
 - a. Slightly below eye level b. Slightly above eye level
 - c. Slightly vertical to eye level d. None of the above

2. Fill in the blanks with appropriate words given below.

Network switch, Output devices, System software, Application software, Router.

- i. A good digital citizen has the _____ and skill to use information properly.
- ii. _____ is a law that stops you from using other people's work without their permission.
- iii. Your arms should be _____ to the floor and relaxed at your sides.
- iv. A _____ is a person who belongs to a country or nation.
- v. Spending too much time on screens can be bad for our health and make us feel _____ or sad.

3. Provide the descriptive answers of the following questions.

- i. Explain the significance of digital citizenship.
- ii. How should you behave online as a good citizen?
- iii. Discuss in detail the ethical issues of ICT while surfing online.
- iv. Write down health-related issues associated with children using ICT devices.
- v. Define the below given terms.
 - a. Digital Foot Print b. Cyber Crime
 - c. Copy Right Law d. Citizenship
 - d. Cyberbullying

4. Class activity

- i. Divide the class into four groups, each group will give a presentation on one health-related issue of using ICT devices and also give their suggestion on how to minimize the risk related to that particular health issue.

Plagiarism, Piracy and Copyright laws these three terms are very closely related to each other the teacher arranges an activity in class where students enlist different actions done online that can fall into the above categories. So they can understand these terms properly.

Instructions for Teachers

- Involve students in making colorful charts that describe good digital citizen characteristics.
- Engage the student to practice digital citizenship in their daily online lives.
- Throw a group discussion in class about internet ethics and why they should behave ethically online.
- Demonstrate proper posture and poor posture while using ICT devices in the computer lab.
- Make a PowerPoint presentation on cybercrime related to children and show it to your students in the computer lab so they can have awareness about cybercrime-related children.